

Absolutely — **afford** is a strong target because your passage uses it here:

> “...probably far beyond anything I could ever **afford**.”

Here **afford** means **to have enough money to pay for something without causing serious financial difficulty**. But the word also extends beyond money to **time, opportunity, risk, loss, and giving/providing something**.

Word family: **afford / affordable / affordability**

Base word: afford

Verb forms: afford, affords, afforded, affording

Related adjective: affordable

Related noun: affordability

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Your source sentence:

> “...probably far beyond anything I could ever **afford**.”

Meaning in your passage: **afford = have enough money to pay for something — 負擔得起；買得起**

Here **afford** means:

> **to have enough money to pay for something while still being able to meet other necessary expenses.**

繁體中文：

有足夠金錢支付某物 / 某項服務，而不至於造成難以承受的經濟負擔；負擔得起、買得起

Natural translation:

> “...far beyond anything I could ever afford.”

「.....遠遠超出我**負擔得起的範圍**。」

So here:

> **afford = 有能力支付**

1. **afford + noun = 負擔得起；買得起**

The core financial meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “It was far beyond anything I could ever **afford**.”

「那遠遠超出我**負擔得起的範圍**。」

Practice 2

> “I can’t **afford** that painting.”

「我**買不起 / 負擔不起**那幅畫。」

Practice 3

> “They can afford a larger apartment now.”

「他們現在**負擔得起**一間較大的公寓。」

afford = 有足夠金錢支付某物而不造成過大財務壓力

2. **can afford to + verb** = 有能力做.....；負擔得起做.....

A major grammar pattern.

Practice 4

> “We can’t **afford to buy** the original.”

「我們**負擔不起購買**原作。」

Practice 5

> “She can afford to travel twice a year.”

「她有經濟能力**每年旅行兩次**。」

afford to do = 有足夠金錢 / 資源去做某件事

3. **can’t afford to + verb** = 不能承受.....後果；不能冒.....風險

A very important figurative extension.

Practice 6

> “We can’t **afford to make** another mistake.”

「我們**承受不起再犯一次錯的後果**。」

Practice 7

> “The museum cannot afford to damage the painting.”

「博物館**承受不起損壞畫作的後果**。」

can’t afford to do = 某行動可能帶來太大損失、風險或後果，因此不能做

This is not mainly about money.

4. **can’t afford + noun = 承受不起.....的損失 / 代價**

Practice 8

> “The company can’t **afford another delay**.”

「公司**承受不起再次延誤**。」

Practice 9

> “We cannot afford any more mistakes.”

「我們**再也承受不起任何錯誤**。」

afford = 有能力承受某事件造成的代價或負面後果

5. **afford the time = 抽得出時間；有時間可以花**

A common non-financial extension.

Practice 10

> “I can’t **afford the time** to visit today.”

「我今天**抽不出時間**去參觀。」

Practice 11

> “Can you afford an hour to look through the collection?”

「你能不能**抽出一小時**看看這批館藏？」

****afford + time = 有足夠可用時間去做某事****

This extends the core idea from money to another limited resource.

6. ****can afford to wait / delay = 有條件等；承受得起等待****

Practice 12

> “We can ****afford to wait**** until next month.”

「我們**等到下個月也沒問題 / 有條件等**。」

Practice 13

> “Small businesses often cannot afford to wait for payment.”

「小企業往往**承受不起長時間等待付款**。」

****afford to wait = 有足夠時間、資源或安全空間承受等待****

7. ****afford someone something = give/provide someone with something — 給予；提供****

A distinct formal meaning.

Practice 14

> “The window ****affords visitors a beautiful view**** of the garden.”

「這扇窗**讓訪客可以欣賞到**花園的美景。」

Practice 15

> “The job **afforded** her valuable experience.”

「這份工作**給予她寶貴的經驗**。」

****afford someone something = 提供 / 給予某人某種機會、好處、視野或經驗****

Register:

* formal

* written English

This is one of the most important non-financial meanings.

8. ****afford + opportunity/chance = 提供機會****

Practice 16

> “The exhibition ****affords**** students an opportunity to study the original works.”

「這個展覽****為學生提供機會****研究原作。」

Practice 17

> “The course afforded me the chance to work with artists.”

「這個課程****給了我機會****與藝術家合作。」

****afford = 提供某種機會或可能性****

This belongs conceptually with #7.

9. ****afford + view/access/protection = 提供 ; 給予****

Practice 18

> “The balcony affords a clear view of the river.”

「這個露台****可以清楚看到****河景。」

Practice 19

> “The wall affords some protection from the wind.”

「這道牆**提供了一定的擋風保護**。」

****afford = 使某人能獲得某種視野、保護、便利或好處****

Formal.

10. ****affordable = not too expensive — 負擔得起的；價格合理的****

A major related adjective.

Practice 20

> “I’m looking for an ****affordable**** reproduction.”

「我正在找一幅****價格負擔得起的****複製畫。」

Practice 21

> “The museum offers affordable tickets for students.”

「博物館提供學生****價格較相宜的門票****。」

****affordable = 價格不高到超出目標群體合理負擔能力的****

Important:

> affordable ≠ cheap

Something can be affordable without being very cheap.

11. ****affordable housing = 可負擔房屋；可負擔住房****

A major policy/economic compound.

Practice 22

> “The city needs more ****affordable housing****.”

「這座城市需要更多****可負擔住房****。」

Practice 23

> “Affordable housing remains a major issue.”

「**可負擔房屋**仍然是一個重要議題。」

affordable housing = 價格 / 租金對目標收入群體而言可合理負擔的住房

This is a lexicalized policy term.

12. **affordability = affordability / ability to pay — 可負擔程度；負擔能力**

Practice 24

> “Housing **affordability** has become a serious concern.”

「住房**可負擔程度 / 負擔能力**已成為嚴重問題。」

Practice 25

> “The study compares the affordability of different cities.”

「這項研究比較不同城市的**生活 / 住房負擔能力**。」

affordability = 某商品、服務或住房相對於收入是否容易負擔的程度

13. **make something more affordable = 令……更容易負擔**

A very common modern pattern.

Practice 26

> “Digital reproductions make art more **affordable**.”

「數碼複製品令藝術品變得**更容易負擔**。」

Practice 27

> “The discount makes the course more affordable.”

「折扣令這個課程**更負擔得起**。」

make X affordable = 降低實際 / 相對成本，使更多人有能力支付

Important distinction: **afford vs cost**

Directly relevant to your passage.

cost

focuses on the thing:

> “The painting costs \$5,000.”

= 畫作要價 5,000 元。

afford

focuses on the buyer:

> “I can afford \$5,000.”

= 我有能力負擔 5,000 元。

So:

> **cost** = 要多少錢

> **afford** = 我付不付得起

Important distinction: **afford vs pay**

pay

= actually give money.

afford

= have the financial ability to pay.

> “I can pay \$500 today.”

= 我今天可以付款 500 元。

> “I can afford \$500.”

= 500 元在我的負擔能力內。

Someone may technically be able to pay now but not truly be able to **afford** it without financial strain.

Important distinction: **afford vs buy**

buy

= purchase something.

afford

= have enough resources to purchase it.

> “I want to buy it.”

= 我想買。

> “I can afford it.”

= 我買得起。

Wanting or buying is different from financial capacity.

Important distinction: **afford vs worth**

afford

= whether the buyer has enough resources.

worth

= whether the item/value justifies or equals a certain amount.

> “I can afford the painting.”

= 我買得起。

> “The painting is worth \$5,000.”

= 畫作值 5,000 元。

> “It’s worth buying.”

= 值得買。

Three different concepts.

Important distinction: **afford vs budget**

budget

= plan how much money can be spent.

afford

= actually have enough financial capacity.

> “We budgeted \$2,000.”

= 我們預算了 2,000 元。

> “We can afford \$2,000.”

= 我們有能力負擔 2,000 元。

A budget is a plan; affordability is capacity.

Important distinction: **afford vs affordable**

afford

verb:

> “I can afford it.”

= 我負擔得起。

affordable

adjective:

> “It is affordable.”

= 它的價格在可負擔範圍內。

Perspective differs slightly:

* afford → person's ability

* affordable → item's price relative to buyers

Important distinction: **affordable vs cheap**

cheap

= low-priced.

affordable

= reasonably within someone's financial means.

A \$2,000 laptop may not be cheap, but for a particular buyer it may be affordable.

So:

> cheap = 價格低

> affordable = 負擔得起

Important distinction: **can't afford it — literal vs figurative**

Financial:

> "I can't afford the painting."

= 我買不起這幅畫。

Figurative:

> "We can't afford another mistake."

= 我們承受不起再犯錯的後果。

This is one of the highest-value MCQ contrasts.

Important distinction: ****afford to do vs allow yourself to do****

Sometimes:

> “I can’t afford to relax.”

means:

> I do not have enough time/safety/resources to relax.

It does ****not**** necessarily mean:

> I cannot permit myself morally.

Compare:

* can’t afford to relax = 沒有條件放鬆

* won’t allow myself to relax = 不允許自己放鬆

Important distinction: ****afford someone something vs afford something****

Financial:

> “I can afford the ticket.”

= 我買得起門票。

Formal provide:

> “The balcony affords us a good view.”

= 露台為我們提供良好視野。

Same verb, completely different syntax and meaning.

Important grammar note: ****afford + noun / afford to + verb****

Natural:

> afford the ticket

> afford a holiday

> afford to travel

> afford to wait

Not:

> *afford travelling* ❌

> in the normal financial sense.

Use:

> afford **to travel**

Important grammar note: **afford is commonly used with can/could/be able to**

Very common:

> can afford

> can't afford

> could afford

> couldn't afford

> be able to afford

Examples:

> "I can afford it."

> "I couldn't afford it then."

Because **afford** usually discusses ability/capacity.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **afford + noun — money** = 負擔得起 / 買得起

* **afford to + verb — money/resources** = 有能力做.....

* **can't afford to + verb — consequences** = 承受不起.....後果

* **can't afford + noun — risk/loss** = 承受不起.....

* **afford time** = 抽得出 / 有足夠時間

* **afford to wait** = 有條件承受等待

* **afford someone something** = 給予 / 提供某人某物

* **afford an opportunity/chance** = 提供機會

* **afford a view/protection** = 提供視野 / 保護

* **affordable** = 負擔得起的 / 價格合理的

* **affordable housing** = 可負擔住房
* **affordability** = 可負擔程度 / 負擔能力

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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afford — financial	有足夠金錢支付某物 / 服務，而不造成難以承受的經濟壓力
afford to + verb	有足夠金錢、時間或其他資源去做某事
can't afford to + verb	某行動可能帶來過大損失 / 風險，因此不能承受去做
can't afford + noun	沒有能力承受某個損失、延誤、錯誤或風險
afford time	有足夠可用時間去做某事
afford someone something	正式用法：提供 / 給予某人某種機會、好處、經驗或視野
affordable	價格在目標使用者 / 買家的合理負擔能力範圍內
affordable housing	價格或租金對目標收入群體而言可合理負擔的住房
affordability	商品、服務、住房等相對收入而言是否容易負擔的程度

For your original sentence

> “It would cost a fortune, probably far beyond **anything I could ever afford**.”

The exact meaning is:

afford = 我的財務能力是否足以支付 Monet 原作的價格；這裡答案顯然是否定的

Natural translation:

> **「那肯定要花上一大筆錢，恐怕遠遠超出我的負擔能力。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **afford a painting** → 買得起 / 負擔得起一幅畫
- > **afford to travel** → 有經濟 / 資源能力旅行
- > **can't afford another mistake** → 承受不起再犯一次錯
- > **afford the time** → 抽得出時間
- > **afford someone an opportunity** → 為某人提供機會
- > **affordable** → 負擔得起的
- > **affordability** → 可負擔程度
- > **cost vs afford** → 物件要多少錢 vs 買家付不付得起